Two complementary pricing experiments

Before study collection: scripted controls, endpoint checks and canaries

EXPERIMENT 1
Individual and joint deterrence

3 LLM sellers • 150 parent rounds
Save the parent checkpoint

20-round all-LLM reference
Test the prescribed cut against replayed rival prices

If eligible: select seller A; restart all branches at the parent checkpoint

LIVE RIVALS × A'S PRICE PATH

Neither 00	B only 10	C only 01	Both 11
No cut	No cut	No cut	No cut
Cut	Cut	Cut	Cut

8 branches × 20 rounds + A/A repeat
A's cut: 10% for the first 10 rounds

Within-game cut gains: G00, G10, G01, G11
Primary summaries: S, J, M and S − J

EXPERIMENT 2
Pricing after retaliation removal

1 LLM seller + scripted rival
100 parent rounds; fixed checkpoint

Fresh fixed-rival baseline for every completed parent; only calm rival states enter removal branches

At calm checkpoints: restart all branches from the same history

RIVAL POLICY × SELLER CONTEXT

	Kept	Reset
Retained	Neutral text	Neutral text
Removed	Neutral text	Neutral text

+ 2 disclosure branches + A/A repeat
Each path lasts 20 rounds

Primary: removed − retained mean price with context kept (paired within parent)

Keep ineligible, non-calm and incomplete games in accounting. Branches are not independent samples.